

BOARD-STAFF COMMUNICATIONS

The School Board desires to maintain open channels of communication between itself and its employees. To facilitate and ensure such communication, the Board provides various channels and encourages their use.

- A. Direct Communication to the School Board. Any employee, acting as an individual or as a representative of any employee group, may address the Board during the time provided for public input at regular School Board meetings or at any public hearing. Employees wishing to address the Board in this manner shall follow the procedures of Policy 2520.
- B. Communication through Standing Committees. Any employee, acting as an individual or as a representative of any employee group, may recommend a change to any School Board policy. Such recommendations may be submitted in writing to the Chair of the School Board, who in consultation with the Superintendent or designee(s), will forward the recommendation to the appropriate committee Chair. Standing committees' dates and times are published on the LCPS website (<https://www.lcps.org/>). The Chair of the committee may schedule such requests as the agenda permits.
- C. Communication through the Superintendent. Any employee, acting as an individual or as a representative of any employee group, may request a meeting with the Superintendent or designee(s) to discuss policies or other matters for communication to the School Board. The Superintendent may also schedule such meetings and invite employees, including representatives of employee groups, to be present to discuss matters that affect them.
- D. Communication through Immediate Supervisor. Any employee, acting as an individual or as a representative of any employee group, may request a meeting with their immediate supervisor to discuss policies or other matters of interest on an informal basis. The immediate supervisor should respond to questions and other matters of concern that can be handled at that level. If the immediate supervisor does not have the information necessary to respond to the question or concern, they should obtain it and reply within a reasonable time or elevate the matter to the next highest level of supervision. Any question or concern that, through this system of elevating to the next highest level of supervision, is elevated to the Superintendent's level shall be reported by the Superintendent to the School Board Chair.
- E. Communication through School Visitation. School Board members may visit schools to meet with employees to discuss matters of interest or concern. Such visits and meetings shall be scheduled in advance through the principal of the school.
- F. Communication with Individual Board Members. Board members and employees share a common interest in education and in school operation. Informal communication on matters of mutual interest and concern is encouraged, except that discussions of personalities or personal grievances must be avoided. Employees must remember that individual Board members have no authority or duty, except as members of the Board at a

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legally convened Board meeting or except as may be assigned to them by the School Board as a whole. Therefore, employees should not interpret informal remarks of Board members as representing the official position of the Board or a firm position of a Board member.

G. Complaints and Grievances. This policy is intended to provide means of communication between the School Board and employees on matters of mutual concern and interest. It shall not be used in lieu of or to supplement the grievance procedures described in other School Board policies (e.g., Policies 7014, 7018, and 7024).

[Former Policy 2-30]

Adopted: 10/14/80

Revised: 8/13/85, 6/22/93, 9/28/10

Current Revision: 2/27/18

Confirmed: 4/10/23 (with technical changes)

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia, 1950, as amended §§ [22.1-71](#); [22.1-253.13:7](#)(C)(1)

Cross Refs: Policy [2520](#), Participation by the Public, Policy [7014](#), Harassment and Discrimination, Policy [7018](#), Procedure for Adjusting Grievances, Policy [7024](#), Classified Employee Dismissal and Demotion Grievance Procedures